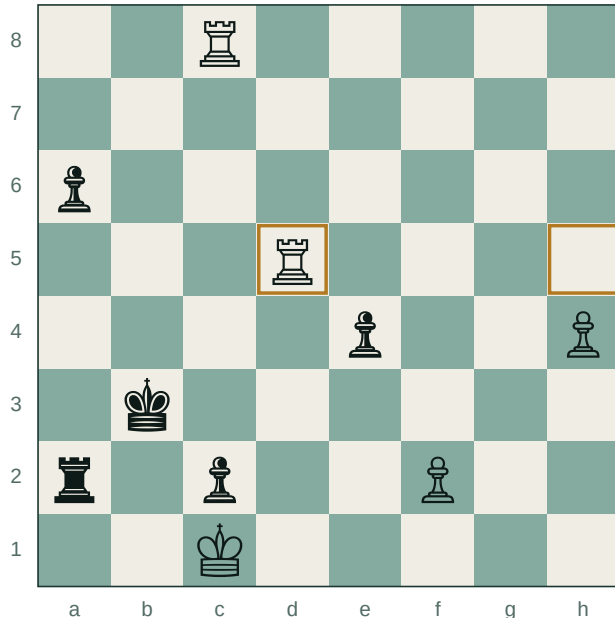


Skewers: Black, move 51

Skewers

Black to move



Previous move: 51.Rxd5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

51...Ra1+ 52. Kd2 Rd1+ 53. Ke3 Rxd5

51...Ra1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **52.Kd2**.

52...Rd1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **53.Ke3**.

53...Rxd5 The rook captures the rook on d5.

At the end, nominal material is White 7 / Black 8 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -4 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The defender may block, capture the attacker, or protect the rear piece while moving the front one. Alignment alone is not enough.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A skewer puts the more important target in front. When that target moves, a piece behind it may be lost. Checks make the geometry especially forcing.

HOW TO LOOK

Search ranks, files, and diagonals where two enemy pieces line up. Calculate the first target's legal responses.

The defending king is on c1. Geometrically undefended: rook on c8 and rook on d5. Check for tactical protection.